Warriors Show Grit in Loss

By Caleb James

For The Journal

WESTMINISTER – For a quarter, the West-Oak Warriors looked like they were ready to go blow for blow with the unbeaten Franklin County Lions, as the scoreboard stayed locked at zero heading into the second quarter.

The Warriors offense came out of the gate firing on all cylinders with big carries coming from Carter Fountain and Zavier Short, but the momentum came to an end shortly after quarterback Harry Burgess was sacked for a loss. After a quick first quarter, the Lions offense caught fire, putting up 31 points in the second quarter alone.

The explosion of points came primarily from Nava Ware from Franklin county as he scored 2 of the touchdowns going in the second quarter. The Lions ended the game with 329 total rushing yards and turned a defensive score by Jerimiah Mayfield into an avalanche. While the Warriors battled through injuries of 6 players, they eventually broke through for a touchdown in the fourth quarter, ending the game on a high note.

“I am proud of the class that our young men showed tonight, I am disappointed that we lost, the players are disappointed that we lost, but our kids played with class” West-Oak head coach Glen Padgett said “We’re gonna come back better, we made a lot of mistakes tonight, we have to get out of our own way.”

The second quarter told the story. Franklin County’s Carson Cheek opened the scoring with a 12 yard touchdown run just under one minute into the second quarter. Shortly after Jerimiah Mayfield jumped a pass to run a pick-six all the way to the endzone for 65 yards.

“We have got to give a lot of Credit to West-Oak, They are a really well coached ball team, they came out and played better than us that first quarter, it felt like the second quarter we finally settled in” Franklin County head coach Chuck Holland said following the game.

West-Oak finally found a bright spot in the fourth quarter, when running back Carter Fountain put the Warriors on the scoreboard with a 23-yard touchdown run down the middle to put the Warriors on the board with 9:20 left to play. Fountain finished with 70 yards on 12 carries.

Franklin County relied heavily on the run game, with a standout performance from senior Nava Ware. Carson Cheek also stood out for the Lions, with two catches for 54 yards to complement his two rushing scores.

Despite the loss, coach Padgett pointed to the lessons his team can carry into the coming weeks.

“Our kids battled, and we’re gonna get better because of this…I can promise you this, we’re gonna have a great week of practice.”

The Warriors continue their homestand next week as they host Landrum, hoping to bounce back and get and return to the win column.

West-Oak 7, Franklin County 34

WOHS 0 0 0 7 — 7

FCHS 0 31 3 0 — 34

SCORING SUMMARY

First Quarter

Second Quarter

FCHS — Cheek 12 run (Robertson kick), 11:06

FCHS — Mayfield 65 pick six (Robertson kick), 09:07

FCHS — Ware 30 run (Robertson kick), 06:55

FCHS — Cheek 38 run (Robertson kick), 4:48

FCHS — Robertson 23 field goal, 00:02

Third Quarter

FCHS — Robertson 11 field goal, 3:37

Fourth Quarter

WOHS — Fountain 23 run (Vargas kick), 9:20

TEAM STATISTICS

WOHS FCHS

First Downs 12 13

Total Yards 212 377

Rushes-Yards 33-155 37-329

Fumbles-Lost 2-1 1-0

Com-Att-Int 7-19-3 5-7-0

Passing Yards 57 48

Pen-Yards 3-15 16-160

Punts-Avg. 4-39.25 4-35.75

—

INDIVIDUAL STATISTICS

RUSHING — Franklin County, Ware 5-64, Appleby 7-35, West-Oak, Fountain 12-70, Ballard 4-39

PASSING — Franklin County, Harbin 5-7-0 76; Burgess 5-8-2 52

RECEIVING — Franklin County, Cheek 2-54, West-Oak, Sheriff 2-18, Short 2-12